bottom of a Victorian slammer. The message is to other people: “Wish you were here.”’

As the days wore on documents began to appear under my cell door, some of them delivered at night, ushered in by whispers. A lot of them were newspaper clippings or articles downloaded and annotated by the prisoner. ‘Is Rape Rampant in Gender-Equal Sweden?’ said one article. Conspiracy abounds in the confines of a prison, but so does lawyerly empathy: the incarcerated ones have experience, obviously, and many are tough on themselves and tough on the system that surrounds them, taking it for granted that the prison culture can seek to exploit you. Many among my traffic of correspondents – my placers of things under the door – were veritable experts in the miscarriage of justice, which soothed me in the wee small hours. It would be an indulgence to think that all prisoners are innocent, but some of us are, and I felt the documents and letters were a kind of solidarity. There’s a lot of anger, too, and I felt angry as I tried to exercise in that small space, walking in a figure of eight like a demented bee.

One morning an envelope arrived with nothing inside. I stood at the window and saw it was still snowing. I think it was 10 December. I later found out the envelope had originally contained a copy of *Time* magazine. My face was on the cover with an American flag covering my mouth. The leader article called me ‘an exceptionally talented showman’. Maybe I am, but I didn’t feel like it at that moment. Instead of reading *Time*, I had to do time, and to break the monotony I continued to look for other things in the draughty space beneath the door, the stuff meant for Prisoner Number A9379AY. That’s how it works, keeping you quiet, keeping you in the dark, reducing you to a serial number, while you look for the light that’s beneath doors and beyond walls.

One of the most enlightening articles posted under my door came from a prisoner called Shawn Sullivan. It was a copy of ‘the Extradition Treaty Between the Government of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and the Government of the United States of America’, signed by David Blunkett and John Ashcroft in March 2003. Article 7 related to Capital Punishment, suggesting that a state of whom extradition is requested might refuse if the requesting country considers the offence to be punishable by the death penalty. American politicians had already called for my extradition to face charges under the espionage act. Congressman Peter